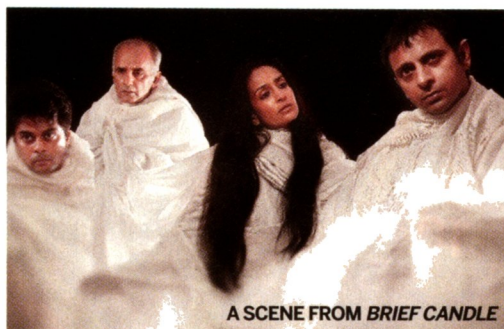


ART EXHIBITION

All About Love

Mumbai's The Strand Art Room's latest exhibition, 11 Curls, is a display of 11 artists' works from Baroda. They use drawings, paintings and sculptures to represent their perceptions of love and desire and steer away from hearts-and-flowers clichés. The exhibition includes the works of Ambubhai Rathwa, Momin Nissar, Hardik Kansara and Shital Panchal. They will be displayed on August 7 to 30.

by Pankti Mehta



A SCENE FROM BRIEF CANDLE

THEATRE

End BENDER

It's definitely not macabre but this is perhaps the first play where death is given a humorous twist. Director-producer Lillete Dubey and playwright Mahesh Dattani have come together with a new production *Brief Candle* for the aid of cancer patients. While Dattani has drawn from his own life as he lost his mother to cancer, Dubey

has worked with cancer patients. The play shows the positive side of life, even when it comes to the terminally ill. It revolves around a hospital, where a doctor and some patients decide to put up a play written by an inmate. It is a farce in which characters await their departure at an airport lounge,

where some are caught up in comic situations and others are embroiled in complicated love affairs. During rehearsal, the inmates discover the similarities between themselves and the roles they essay. The cast includes Joy Sengupta, Amar Talwar, Suchitra Pillai, Satchit Puranik and Manasi Parekh. At St. Andrews Auditorium on August 9, and the National Centre for Performing Arts, both in Mumbai, on August 22.

by Swati Mathur

FILM REVIEW

LOVE AAJ KAL

Updated Formula

RATING ★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆

Director: Imtiaz Ali

Starring: Saif Ali Khan, Deepika Padukone, Rishi Kapoor

Romantic comedies usually end with the woman brought to her knees or the man on his, with a ring in his hand and a craven apology on his lips. *Love Aaj Kal* is no different. When the closet Majnu realises the woman he had broken up with at the beginning of the film is actually the love of his life, he is down on his haunches, bleeding, on a San Francisco pavement. By then he has had long conversations and lots of coffee (black, no sugar) with an older man who naturally tells him

to think with his *dil*, not *dimaag*. He has also worked his way through a series of girlfriends, some of whose names he has to check after he sleeps with them. The film has lots of travel, by trains, planes, cars, cycles, cycle rickshaws, and even trams. In case we don't get the reference, that love is a journey but all of us have to find our own paths to a happy ending, director Imtiaz Ali throws in lots of bridges as well. Moving in time and space, between 1965 and now, across Kolkata, London, San Francisco and Delhi, it tries to graft the feeling of an epic on what is essentially a simple story: of a woman waiting for

the man-boy in her life to grow up, without appearing to. Love, modern style, is emphasised repeatedly. It is not the silent glance, the barely-there touching and the patient longing. It is instead instant communication, being on facebook, chatting on the Internet, SMS, and blameless break-ups. It's not a timeless classic but quietly classy.

by Kaveree Bamzai

